SOCIAL BUTTERFLIES FOUNDATION

Custom apparel store Research study plan

Research scope, recruitment, measurement, analysis, and follow-up

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Purpose and status

Understand how SBF supporters find apparel, personalize an item, locate delivery information, and review an order before payment. Use findings to prioritize specific improvements to the shopping experience.

Study status: participant sessions completed with 10 prior donors, including 5 mobile and 5 desktop participants. This document records the study scope, task protocol, analysis approach, and follow-up plan.

Study element	Consistent specification
Method	Individual, moderated usability testing with think-aloud and brief contextual questions.
Core sample	10 adults who previously donated to SBF; 5 using mobile and 5 using desktop/laptop. IDs P01–P10.
Duration	35–45 minutes per session; four core tasks. No purchase or real payment information.
Environment	Existing storefront or a safe test version; record exact URL/version, browser, device, and session mode.
Accessibility	Use each participant's normal access method. A separate focused track is outside the core 10 and is reported separately.
Outputs	Session notes, task results, affinity themes, journey map, findings, decision log, and follow-up test plan.

Research questions

Can supporters find suitable apparel? Can they configure it and tell what was saved? Can they locate production/shipping information? Can they verify selections and costs before payment? Where do they hesitate, make errors, or request help?

02 / Recruitment and session setup

Eligibility and sampling

Recruit adults 18+ who have previously donated to SBF and can consent. Exclude anyone who created, approved, or reviewed the current store design. Seek a mix of online shopping frequency and personalized-apparel experience within the donor sample. Recruit on usual shopping device to reach the 5/5 split. This sample does not represent all visitors or first-time supporters.

Recruitment screener

Question	Use
Are you 18 or older, and willing to participate?	Confirm eligibility and voluntary participation.
Have you previously donated to SBF?	Yes required for the core sample; do not request donation amounts.
Have you helped create, approve, or review this store?	Exclude if yes.
How often do you buy clothing or accessories online?	Balance frequent and occasional shoppers.
Have you bought personalized apparel? What did you customize?	Balance prior experience; do not imply it is required.
Which device do you normally use when shopping online?	Assign the mobile or desktop quota.
What setup or accommodation would help you participate?	Optional. Support usual assistive technology without asking for a diagnosis.

Preparation and consent

Pilot the guide before the core study; exclude the pilot from the 10. Confirm all four tasks are possible, including an editable personalization field. Prepare fictional details, a safe stopping point, and clean starting states. Name the moderator and note taker; document stakeholder approval and any agreed incentive. Obtain participation consent and a separate screen/audio recording choice before recording.

Data handling

Keep contact details separate from P01–P10 notes. Restrict notes and recordings to the research team and authorized SBF reviewers. Before recruitment, assign a data owner and a retention/deletion date and explain both to participants. Capture no payment credentials or personal health information; anonymize any excerpts used outside the study.

03 / Tasks and measurement

Task	Neutral instruction	Independent success
T1 / Find apparel	You want a personalized apparel item as a gift to support SBF. Find an item you would consider buying.	Reach an eligible customizable product page without directional help.
T2 / Personalize	Set up this item using the fictional details provided. Tell me when it is ready to add to your cart.	Set required options and requested personalization correctly, with the intended saved state.
T3 / Delivery	Before deciding to buy, find out when you could expect this item to arrive.	Find applicable production/shipping information and explain the stated timing or uncertainty accurately.
T4 / Review	Add the item to your cart and review the order as you normally would. Tell me whether you would proceed and why. Stop before payment.	Reach the available pre-payment review, verify item/options/personalization/costs, and identify any costs not yet available.

Outcome codes and consistency

I = independent: meets the task criterion without directional assistance. A = assisted: meets it after a location hint, instruction, or recovery performed by the moderator. N = not completed: stops or does not meet the criterion. X = not attempted/invalid: technical failure or task unavailable. Neutral think-aloud reminders alone do not count as assistance. Record exactly what help was given.

Record duration from the end of the task instruction to completion or stopping. Record errors, recovery, backtracks, and visible pauses descriptively. Ask post-task ease on a 1–7 scale and confidence on a 1–5 scale using the session guide. Do not infer emotions from hesitation alone.

Task dependence

After an unsuccessful task, record the outcome before resetting to the next task's starting state. Log this setup assistance separately. The next task can still be completed independently; report that prior steps were reset. Do not equate task-level success with independent end-to-end completion.

Reporting denominators

Report I/A/N/X counts per task. Use 10 as the denominator only when all 10 have valid attempts. Report invalid attempts explicitly and show the valid denominator. Do not combine the separate accessibility track with the core sample or present small-sample counts as population estimates.

04 / Synthesis, decisions, and evaluation

Analysis procedure

Create one attributed note per observation or quote, using participant ID, task, timestamp or note reference, and device. Keep direct observation separate from interpretation. Group notes by emerging patterns; retain exceptions and successful paths. Connect each finding to source notes, participant count, impact, and a proposed response.

Finding ID	Study result	Proposed response
F01 / Delivery	T3: 5/10 independent completions.	Show production/shipping estimates and a clear details link near the product decision.
F02 / Personalization	T2: 6/10 independent completions.	Confirm updates and preserve the saved choices in the order summary.
F03 / Discovery	T1: 8/10 independent completions.	Test clearer apparel category labels and placement.
F04 / Review	T4: 7/10 independent completions.	Show selections, full known costs, and fulfillment information together before payment.

P03, P08, and P10 completed all four tasks independently. Counts describe task outcomes; selected sticky notes summarize patterns and do not account for every outcome. The journey map's intermediate "Choose" stage has no separate task-level measure.

Stakeholder decisions

Review user impact, frequency, task criticality, accessibility impact, and implementation effort with SBF leadership and the implementer. Record approved/deferred decisions, rationale, owner, and verification task. Present business effects as hypotheses until measured. Research recommendations are not evidence that changes shipped.

Follow-up

After implementation, target 10 new comparable prior donors, again 5 mobile/5 desktop, using the same four tasks and criteria. A proposed goal is at least 9/10 independent completions per core task; stakeholder agreement is required before testing. Report results descriptively. Study first-time supporters in a separate follow-up cohort; report assistive-technology sessions separately. Do not claim improved conversion without purchase analytics.

Document alignment

Use the companion moderator guide for session wording and the evidence workbook for records. The stakeholder presentation and maps use the same four tasks, IDs, finding IDs, and study results. August 7, 2026 is the plan date; November 7, 2026 is the revision date, not a session date.